263-5351-00L - Machine Learning For Genomics

Paper presentation guidelines

Organization

In the second part of the course, you will have an opportunity to **either solve a second project or present a paper** linked to the material of the course. It is mandatory to solve at least one project, you can't present more than one paper.

You can choose a paper to present by adding a column with your name to this shared document. Please do not remove any existing text/columns.

If you choose to present a paper, here are the **requirements** and some **recommendations** to fulfill the task correctly and obtain the best possible evaluation.

Requirements

The presentation should respect the following guidelines:

- The presentation should be **25 min long** (part 1), **with questions and further interaction with the audience 10 min long** (part 2) (see next points). You will be reminded of the remaining time for part 1 1 min before the end of the allocated time and will be cut if you supersede the 25 min mark. You will then be reminded once again 1 min before the end for part 2 and will be cut if overtime.
- You will receive **an exam-like question** ahead of time (about 7 days before the presentation) that you will have to answer about the paper you will present. You are expected to **present your attempted answer** at the end of the presentation, after your conclusion. **This section belongs to part 2**. If you wish, you can contact a TA beforehand to discuss the answer with them (beware, this should not be abused!)
- We also ask you to **prepare at least two questions for the audience** and moderate a small discussion section at the end of your presentation. **This section belongs to part 2.**
- You will have to upload the presentation slides to a folder shared with the professor and TAs by the day before the presentation at the latest: https://cloud.inf.ethz.ch/s/tBRxHGbXZeQ3Jzr Please follow the format PP<i>.<name>.<family name>.[pdf|pptx]

Recommendations

- We recommend that you **structure your presentation** in the following manner:
  - **Introduction:** you should put the study **into context**, using class material when relevant. Please, provide necessary CS or biological background when the topic has not been covered in the class.
  - **Methods:** although you should be familiar with the methods in detail (including anything hidden in supplementary!) you should present it so that it is **accessible to someone who hasn't read the paper in as much detail as you have**. It is always a good idea to have a couple hidden slides at the end of the presentation to follow-up on specific questions the audience might have.
  - **Results:** you should **highlight the main results** of the article and their **relevance**. You probably will not have the time to go through every result presented, so we will not expect you to cover every single point in your main presentation. It is up to you to decide how much time you want to spend on the method itself or on its applications - consider what you found more interesting yourself.
  - **Discussion: Be critical about the article!** This does not necessarily mean that you need to find a lot of weak points (some articles might be harder to criticize than others!) but you should put the contributions **into context**, understand the **relevance** and **importance** of the paper, and its **limitations.** This section is also your opportunity to i**nteract more with the audience**, via the questions or any means you deem relevant.
- On a more general note, we will also be looking for **your capacity to communicate clearly a message to the audience**. This also encompasses making the presentation somewhat **entertaining** and keeping your audience concentrated throughout. This can be done through language, the way you interact with the audience but also by picking the right material to present.

Email addresses

Professor: Prof. Valentina Boeva valentina.boeva@inf.ethz.ch
Head TA: Lovro Rabuzin lovro.rabuzin@inf.ethz.ch
TA: Anna Kalygina anna.kalygina@inf.ethz.ch

Website to bid for a paper (first come first served): ML4G'26 paper bidding (DEADLINE: 7.10.2025)
Website to upload your presentation: https://cloud.inf.ethz.ch/s/tBRxHGbXZeQ3Jzr . Please follow the format PP<i>.<name>.<family name>.[pdf|pptx]